

6.7 Fallback

Under Article 6 of the Union Customs Code (UCC), all exchanges of information between Customs Authorities and economic operators must be made using electronic data processing techniques. However, in the event of a temporary failure of either the Customs Authority or the economic operator's computerised system, the exchange of this information can be completed in a non-electronic format, which is known as Fallback. There is more information on the [Customs fallback service](#) on the Revenue website.

'Fallback' is the term used to describe the business continuity process by which goods for import or export are manually cleared by Customs where an interruption to the Customs electronic systems or ROS occurs. Fallback should only be used for consignments that require urgent release. Declarants should continue to submit declarations although they may not receive a response message.

The paper-based declaration must contain the additional safety and security data specified in Annex 9, Appendix A of the TDA.

The declarant may lodge the completed form(s) to Customs at the office to which their goods will arrive. Physical examination of the goods may be carried by Customs officers as necessary before release.

The declarant must present the goods to the appropriate agency for inspection when required to do so. Proof of such inspections must be available to view on request.

When electronic access is restored, traders should submit the declaration via AIS where not already submitted and the relevant MRN allocated by the system advised to Customs at the office of entry (Article 6(3)(b) of the UCC).

Requests to avail of fallback can be directed to eCustoms Helpdesk.

Tel: 01 738 3677 Email: ecustoms@revenue.ie

There is also an out of hours service that is available from 5pm – 8am, Monday – Friday, and 24 hours on weekends and public holidays.

Tel: 086 032 1714 Email: outofhoursfallback@revenue.ie